

WRITING

A lot of our knowledge of the myths comes from plays and poetry written down by authors in ancient Greece. The epic poems of ancient Greece are very long and tell the stories of gods and heroes.

The poet Homer wrote *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey*, two epic poems that tell the story of the Trojan War and Odysseus's adventures on his way home from Troy.



Friezes were long, stone wall-carvings showing scenes from myths and ancient Greek religious festivals. Many are found in the ruins of temples.

ART

Ancient Greek artists loved to tell the stories of the myths in their work. People could see these images from the myths every day, in all areas of their lives, on everything from vases to temples. Characters were also painted or carved out of stone.

STORYTELLING

One of the main ways that the myths were shared was by storytelling. Not everyone could read, so people would learn the myths by listening to older storytellers, who had memorized them. In this way, the myths were passed down from generation to generation.

Plays were very popular in ancient Greece, and Euripides was a famous playwright. He wrote a play called *Medea* about Medea and her husband, the hero Jason.



Hesiod was a poet who wrote *The Theogony*, which explains the different generations of gods and how they were created, from Gaia to Zeus.

